

Change Management Plan

furlink

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April 2026

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Introduction

Change Management is a critical component of the project. Because the platform relies on complex integrations, unforeseen technical challenges or shifting requirements are inevitable. The Change Management Plan for the project establishes clear expectations on how proposed changes will be vetted, managed, and communicated. If changes to the platform's scope, tech stack, or timeline are implemented in an unorganized manner, the project risks missing critical Capstone milestones. All stakeholders, including the development team and project advisers, are expected to submit and process changes in accordance with the processes detailed in this document.

Change Management Approach

The approach taken to manage change for the furlink project is designed to be highly protective of the core timeline. Because time and scope are rigid constraints dictated by academic deadlines, the primary goal of this approach is to prevent scope creep while allowing necessary technical pivots. The project team will ensure that all proposed changes are rigorously defined and evaluated against the project's ability to hit the completion date. Only changes that are essential to delivering the core MVP will be approved. By maintaining this strict methodology, the development team will focus its limited resources solely on beneficial adjustments, avoiding unnecessary feature enhancements that could jeopardize the final solution release.

Definitions of Change

Several types of changes may be requested and considered during the development of furlink, each carrying different impacts on the overall project plan.

Scope Changes

Any additions or subtractions to the features outlined, such as the AI Booking Assistance's capabilities or altering service provider dashboard metrics.

Technical and Architectural Changes

These refer to the fundamental shifts in the underlying technology stack such as migrating away from Vercel or replacing Supabase with NoSQL solution due to unforeseen limitations.

Scheduling Changes

Scheduling changes impact the approved project timeline, potentially requiring the team to crash the schedule or negotiate an extension for scheduled releases.

Budget Changes

Modifications of financial resources required, which in this context primarily relates to funds needed to upgrade cloud hosting tiers if user traffic exceeds to free limits.

Configuration Change Request (CCR)

A formal document drafted when feedback collected from Pet Owners (PO) or Service Providers (SP) within OpenProject necessitates a departure from the established baseline. All proposed system enhancement or problem resolution must be processed as a CCR.

Change Control Board

For the furlink capstone initiative, the Change Control Board (CCB) functions as the definitive approval authority for all proposed changes to the project's scope, timeline, budget, or multi-cloud infrastructure. Chaired by the Project Adviser and Co-Adviser, and including the Project Manager and Lead Developer, this collaborative group rigorously evaluates technical specifications and requested modifications against strict academic deadlines. The CCB ensures that any authorized changes are absolutely essential to delivering the core MVP and do not introduce scope creep that could jeopardize the final solution release.

Roles and Responsibilities

The following are the roles and responsibilities for all change management efforts related to the furlink Project:

Project Sponsor

- Review and approve any changes that directly impact on the project's budgets and schedule.
- Approve any requirements for additional financial backing.

Project Manager

- Receive and log all change requests from project stakeholders
- Conduct preliminary risk, cost, schedule, scope analysis of change prior to CCB
- Seek clarification from change requestors on any open issues or concerns
- Make documentation revisions/edits as necessary for all approved changes
- Participating in CCB

Project Team

- Submit all change requests on standard organizational change request forms
- Provide all applicable information and detail on change request forms
- Be prepared to address questions regarding any submitted change requests
- Provide feedback as necessary on impact of proposed changes

Project Adviser

- Ensure changes do not violate academic standards, course requirements, or timelines.
- Approve all major shifts in schedule baseline.
- Chair of Change Control Board

Lead Developer

- Draft formal CCRs for requested system departures.
- Authorize and create new feature branches in GitHub to isolate the development of approved changes, ensuring the stable production branch remains protected.

Lead Quality Assurance

- Verify implemented changes against the original user feedback.
- Ensure the enhancement or defect is fully resolved before authorizing the CCR to be marked as closed and integrated into the final release.

Change Control Process

The Change Control Process for the furlink project will follow the organizational standard change process for all projects. The project manager has overall responsibility for executing the change management process for each change request.

Change Classification and Criteria

To prevent bottlenecks, change requests for this project are classified into two categories:

Major Changes: Any modification that alters the project scope, timeline, core architecture, API, or budget. These must strictly follow the full Change Control Process.

Minor Changes: Low-risk, low-impact modifications that will not affect the sprint goal, database schema, or project baseline. These changes do not require a formal CCB assessment or a new Sprint planning alignment. The Project Manager and Lead Developer can mutually approve these changes during the current Sprint Backlog as a task, if it does not jeopardize the current Sprint Backlog.

1. Identify the Need for a Change

The process begins when feedback or defect logs are collected from Pet Owners or Service Providers and documented within OpenProject. Any feedback necessitating a departure from the established software baseline is formulated and drafted as a formal Change Request by the assigned Full-Stack Developer.

2. Preliminary Impact Analysis

Once drafted, the Change Request is routed first to the Project Manager, who conducts a preliminary risk, cost, schedule, and scope analysis. During the analysis, the Project Manager determines if the change qualifies as a Major or a Minor Change. If it is a minor change, it bypasses the formal Change Control Board assessment, moving directly to implement during the current Sprint. If deemed viable, the Project Manager logs the request and formally submits it to the board.

3. Log Change Requests

The project manager will keep a log of all submitted Change Requests throughout the project lifecycle.

4. Obtain Decision on Change Request

The project team, acting collectively as the Change Control Board (CCB), will discuss the proposed change and decide whether it will be approved by evaluating it against

two critical criteria: its alignment with digitizing the pet care market and its technical feasibility within the current tech stack.

5. Implement Change

If a change is approved by the CCB, the project manager will update and re-baseline project documentation as necessary and notify stakeholders. The Lead Developer will authorize a new Feature Branch in GitHub to isolate development. During implementation, any active CCRs or resulting blockers must be reported during daily stand-up meetings. Once built, the Lead Quality Assurance will verify the change against the original feedback before the CCR is closed and integrated into the stable term branch for final

6. Verification and Closure

Following implementation, the Quality Assurance lead must test and verify the code adjustments against the original user feedback to ensure the defect or enhancement is fully resolved. Only after this verification is complete is the Change Request marked as closed in OpenProject, allowing the Lead Full-Stack Developer to safely merge the code into the stable development branch for final release.

Stakeholder Acceptance

Approved by the Project Sponsor:



Manuel R. Doria Jr.

Project Sponsor Representative

Date: May 19, 2026

